APARNA CHEGU

Senior QA Leader | Test Strategy & Architecture | SAP Ariba Specialist | AI-Driven Test Automation | Cloud QA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven QA Leader with 19+ years of experience spanning test strategy design, quality architecture, and release governance across large-scale enterprise programmes. Deep specialisation (10+ years) in complex, integration-heavy enterprise systems — SAP Ariba downstream modules (Catalog, Contracts) and integration layers (CIG, ERP) — comparable in scale and complexity to large BSS/OSS telecom landscapes. Proven track record defining end-to-end test approaches, scenarios and regression scope; owning quality risk identification and communication to stakeholders; and driving release readiness, test environment planning, and deployment verification across cloud-native and on-prem systems. Regularly partners with product owners, technical architects and business stakeholders to clarify requirements and acceptance criteria, bridging business intent with QA execution. Hands-on with AI-assisted automation (Claude Sonnet LLM, GitHub Copilot) and modern CI/CD, reducing release cycles by 40%.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Reduced release cycle time by 40% through automation framework redesign, CI/CD integration (Jenkins + GitHub Actions), and stronger release-readiness / deployment-verification practices.
- Improved team delivery speed by 30% via mentorship, clear ownership models, and quality-risk-driven process optimisation.
- Architected and delivered the complete test strategy and automation suite for SAP BTP Catalog from scratch — including test scenarios, regression scope, and test concepts now the foundation for all ongoing releases.
- Partnered with product owners and technical architects to clarify requirements and acceptance criteria, aligning QA coverage with business scenarios (PRD/FRD-level requirement discussions).
- Recognised with a Spot Award for outstanding contributions to SAP BTP automation and quality engineering excellence at SAP Ariba.
- Championed AI-driven testing using Claude Sonnet LLM & GitHub Copilot — accelerating test development, coverage, and automation opportunity identification across distributed systems.

CORE SKILLS

- Test Strategy & Quality Architecture: Test approach & concept design, test scenario/case design, regression scope definition, quality risk identification & communication
- Release & Delivery Governance: Release readiness, effort estimation & capacity planning, test environment planning, deployment verification, test data planning
- Stakeholder & Requirements Management: Collaboration with architects, product owners, developers, release & project managers; requirements clarification and acceptance criteria definition (PRD/FRD)
- Enterprise Domain Expertise: SAP Ariba (Catalog Manager, Views, Rules, Kits), Contracts, Guided Buying, Inventory Service, CIG, ERP Integration, S/4HANA
- Automation Frameworks: Selenium, Katalon Studio, Playwright, Cucumber (BDD), RestAssured
- AI & Cloud Testing: Claude Sonnet LLM, GitHub Copilot, SAP AI Joule, AWS, GCP, SAP BTP
- Non-Functional & Performance Testing: JMeter, LoadRunner; awareness of NFT principles and quality engineering best practice
- DevOps & CI/CD: Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Docker
- Programming: Python, Java, REST API, Kafka (unit testing)
- Delivery & Leadership: Agile/Scrum, Scrum Master, QA Governance, Audit & Compliance Documentation, Vendor Management
- Testing Types: Functional, Regression, Integration, Performance, UAT, API, UI Automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Consultant Engineer – QA Manager, SAP BTP Catalog | SAP Ariba

Dec 2015 – Present | Bangalore, India | 10+ Years Enterprise/SAP Domain

SAP BTP Catalog — Test Strategy, Quality Architecture & Release Governance

- Owned end-to-end test strategy for the SAP Business Transformation Programme (BTP) — defining test approach, test concepts, scenarios, and regression scope for Catalog Manager, Views, Rules, Kits, Dynamic Pricing, and Inventory Management workflows.

- Designed and implemented AI-assisted automation frameworks using GitHub Copilot and Claude Sonnet-4 LLM — significantly improving test coverage, execution speed, and script maintainability.
- Integrated CI/CD pipelines with Jenkins and GitHub Actions, enabling fully automated build-test-deploy workflows and deployment verification; cut release cycles by 40%.
- Deployed cloud-native products on GCP, ensuring compliance with SAP enterprise transformation standards and audit/compliance documentation requirements.
- Acted as Scrum Master for the BTP project — led sprint planning, retrospectives, release readiness ceremonies, capacity planning and effort estimation.
- Identified, assessed, and communicated software quality risks to stakeholders, keeping test activities aligned with business priorities and project complexity.
- Defined end-to-end QA coverage: functional, regression, integration, and performance testing across distributed cloud systems, including test environment and test data planning.
- Leveraged SAP AI Joule to analyse legacy workflows and benchmark against BTP cloud processes, identifying automation opportunities.
- Served as primary stakeholder contact — collaborated with product managers, technical architects, engineering leads, and business teams to clarify requirements, business scenarios, and acceptance criteria, and to resolve risks.
- Mentored a global team of automation engineers and drove continuous improvement in testing efficiency and quality processes; achieved 30% faster time-to-market for BTP releases.

Inventory Service Module

- Verified functional flows from Inventory Service to ERP via CIG (Cloud Integration Gateway), ensuring real-time MRO stock accuracy.
- Automated UI and REST API test suites using Selenium, RestAssured, and Katalon Studio; applied GitHub Copilot to accelerate script generation and refactoring.
- Handled catalog loading from Ariba Network to buying system; validated Inventory Catalogs on Guided Buying interface.
- Wrote unit test cases for Kafka-related source code; integrated automation suite with Jenkins CI/CD pipelines.

Catalog Content Management (CMS)

- Automated CMS UI using Selenium WebDriver; handled migration scenarios and catalog data migration to SAP S/4HANA for CMS-enabled customers.
- Designed validation, enrichment, and cleansing rules for catalog data ingestion pipelines, including regression coverage for data quality.

Tech Stack: *Selenium, Python, Katalon Studio, Playwright, RestAssured, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GCP, Claude Sonnet LLM, SAP AI Joule, GitHub Copilot*

QA Automation Engineer – ScoreNet Application | FICO

Sept 2011 – May 2014 | Bangalore, India

- Automated functional and regression test suites using Selenium and JUnit, cutting manual testing effort by 50%.
- Developed comprehensive QA strategy covering functional, regression, and performance testing for a financial scoring application, including regulatory/compliance-aligned quality documentation.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to align testing with business and regulatory compliance requirements.

Tech Stack: *Selenium, JUnit, Java, Maven, Jenkins*

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology (B.E.) – Electronics and Communication Engineering
Visvesvaraiah Technological University

CERTIFICATIONS

- AI in Software Testing – Generative AI & Automation (LinkedIn Learning)

WHAT SETS ME APART

- 19+ years combining deep enterprise systems domain knowledge (SAP Ariba, S/4HANA, ERP integration) with hands-on AI-driven automation (LLM, Copilot) and cloud QA expertise — directly transferable to complex, integration-heavy BSS-scale environments.

- Rare end-to-end ownership — from test strategy and quality architecture, through automation framework design and CI/CD integration, to release readiness and stakeholder communication — across enterprise-scale programmes.
- Proven ability to identify and communicate quality risk, reduce release cycles, improve team velocity, and align quality engineering directly with business outcomes.